

High-Performance Computing (HPC)
Used when datasets are too large for normal computers

It consists of

- i. Clusters - collection of linked compo.
- ii. GPUs - loads of cores for parallel math
- iii. Supercomputers - extremely powerful

Cloud Computing

Its models services includes
→ IaaS (Infrastructure as a Service) storage.

PaaS (Platform as a Service)
tools for app development.

SaaS (Software as a Service)
G-mails, Google Docs

Benefits

a. Scalability

Pay-as-you-go

Collaboration.

Base of backup

FUNDAMENTALS OF COMPUTER OPERATION

1) CPU architecture.

It is divided into.

a) Arithmetic Logic Unit (ALU)

performs → Addition / Subtraction

Logic operations

Comparison operations

STA 2102: INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY FOR STATISTICS

Definition of IT

Study, design, development, implementation, support or management of computer-based information system.

Core component

✓ Hardware - physical devices (CPU, disks)

✓ Software - operating systems, applications, statistical programs

✓ Data - raw facts used for analysis

✓ Procedures - rules for using IT system

✓ People - Users, IT professionals, analyst

Data, information, knowledge.

Data refers to raw unprocessed facts eg heart rate = 95 bpm

✓ Information are processed, organized and interpreted data eg patient record

Knowledge refers to application of information to make decision.

Role of IT in modern Society

✓ Health care and biostatistics

✓ Electronic Medical Records (EMRs)

✓ Clinical decision support systems

✓ Modeling of disease spread

✓ Big epidemiological databases

✓ Automated data collection tools

Government

✓ E-Governance, statistical reporting

Population census analytics

Input & output

COMPUTER HARDWARE I

1. Input Devices

Traditional → keyboard
Mouse
Joystick

Advanced:

- ✓ Image scanners
- ✓ Biometrics scanners
- ✓ Digital cameras
- ✓ Barcode readers
- ✓ Voice input systems!

2. Output Devices

Softcopy output

- ✓ Monitor
- ✓ Projectors
- ✓ VR displays

Hardcopy output

✓ Printers

✓ Plotters (Statistical graphics)

Measuring I/O performance

DPI (Dots per inch)

P.P.M (Pages per minute)

COMPUTER HARDWARE II

(Storage & memory)

1. Primary Storage

✓ RAM → type of computer

memory that stores data and instructions temporarily while the computer is running

Features → Volatile Memory

Fast Access

Types of RAM → DRAM & SRAM

b) Control Unit (CU)

Directs operations of CPU

Manages execution of instructions

c) Registers

Small, fast memory inside CPU:

- ✓ Accumulator - temporary storage
- Program Counter - next instruction address
- Memory address (MAR)

Machine Cycle

Every CPU instruction goes through

i) Fetch → get instruction from memory

Decode → interpret instruction

Execute → perform required operations

Store → Save the result

Fetch → Decode → Execute → Store

Performance Measures

✓ Clock speed
measured in GHz

✓ 1 GHz = 1 billion cycles per second

Cache memory

L1 (fastest)

L2

L3 (largest)

Parallel Processing

Used in big data analysis,
Simulation methods, Time-consuming
regressions neural networks &
Real-time high frequency trading

COMPUTER SOFTWARE

1) System Software

Controls and manages the computer hardware. eg OS (operating systems) Windows, Linux

- ✓ Manages hardware
- ✓ Runs and stops programs
- ✓ Handles files & storage

2) Application Software

designed to help users perform specific tasks.

Ex. purpose: word processing (Microsoft Word)

- ✓ Spreadsheets (Excel)
- ✓ Presentations (PowerPoint)

Specialized

- R & R Studio

- Python

- Jupyter

- STATA

Compilers vs Interpreters

Compiler → converts whole program into machine code

Interpreters → Executes lines by line.

Workflow Optimization:

- Automation with macros

- Scripting statistical procedures

- Batch processing of dataset.

✓ ROM - It is non volatile memory that stores data permanently.

features: Non-volatile - Data remains even when it is off

- ✓ Holds BIOS & firmware
- Very reliable.

✓ Cache Memory - The fastest memory

Ex. - Improves CPU efficiency.

Secondary Storage

HDD → Hard disk drive.

features: Mechanical

- large capacity eg 1 TB, 2 TB etc
- Cheaper

SSD - Solid State Drive

- No moving parts

features: Fastest

- lower power consumption

Optical Storage → CDs, DVDs

Cloud Storage - Remote servers accessible via internet.

Disk Organization

Disk has - Platters - round discs

- Surfaces - two sides of each platter

- Sector - small units of storage

- Cluster - group of sectors

- Track - concentric circles

Opening & editing files
 Copying, moving & renaming
 Deleting files
 Backing up files
 File compression
 File security

File system

It controls how files are stored and organized on storage devices

eg NTFS - windows

FAT 32/exFAT - flash drives

ext 4 - linux

File lifecycle

- ✓ Creation
- ✓ Editing
- ✓ Indexing
- ✓ Retrieval
- ✓ Backup
- ✓ Archiving

Data bases - organized

Collection of data that is stored and managed so that it can be easily accessed.

Key terms

Table - contains row & columns

Record - (Row) single entry

Field - column

Primary key - Unique identifier

foreign key - field linking one table to another

DATA FILES & FILE MANAGEMENT

Data files is collection of related data stored on a computer, usually kept on storage devices like HDD

Types of data files

i) Text files - plain text characters
 eg txt, csv

ii) Binary files eg exe, dat,

iii) Structured data files organized in row / columns or key-value pairs eg xls, xlsx

iv) Program files - software instructions
 eg exe, apk, .py, .jar.

v) Multimedia files - images, audio, video

Components of a file

file Name

file Extension

file location

file Size

File management

Refers to process of organizing, naming, storing, accessing, securing and deleting files.

Importance

Prevent loss

Save storage space

Ensures data security

Activities in file management

✓ Creation of file

✓ Naming file

✓ Saving & storing file